

Approval pathway

DA or CDC?

A CDC (complying development certificate) is a fast approval for projects that meet fixed State standards. A DA (development application) is assessed by council on merit. Tick the first list before relying on a CDC.

A CDC is only an option if all of these are true

- ☐ The planning certificate says complying development can be carried out on the land.
- ☐ For new dwellings under the Low Rise Housing Diversity Code, the land is not a heritage item or in a heritage conservation area.
- ☐ For that code, the lot is not a battle-axe lot.
- ☐ On bushfire prone land, the bushfire attack level (BAL) is BAL-29 or lower.
- ☐ The lot meets the code's minimum size and width.
- ☐ The design meets every numeric standard: height, setbacks, site coverage, landscaped area, private open space and parking.

A DA is usually the better route if any of these are true

- ☐ The design needs to depart from a standard, even slightly.
- ☐ The site is steep, irregular or tightly constrained.
- ☐ Heritage, flooding or a higher bushfire rating rules out a CDC.
- ☐ You want room to negotiate the design with council.

As a guide, a complete CDC is often issued within weeks; a DA usually takes months. The choice is a feasibility question, not a preference.